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Chapter # 01

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Intro to Int. Organizations

Definitions:

An International organization is a group of countries that work together to solve common problems.

Complex:-

International organization is a body established by agreements b/w states possessing a permanent structure and defined objectives and procedure for cooperation & decision making in international relations.

Evolution of IOs :

Rise of Sovereign States (1648)

Foundation of the Modern International System:

→ Treaty of Westphalia (1648)

- Ended Thirty Year's War
- Established state sovereignty
- State recognized as legally equal

This is the starting point of modern Int. law. Without sovereign states, there can be no Int. Organiz.

Claude: calls this the beginning of the modern state system

Europe's Struggle for Peace (1815 Onwards)

• Congress of Vienna (1815)

- After Napoleonic Wars
- Aim: Restore balance of power
- Created system of consultation

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• Concert of Europe:-

• Regular diplomatic meetings among major powers.

• No permanent secretariat

• Maintain peace for decades

⇒ This was NOT a formal IO but it introduced:

• Multilateral diplomacy

• Regular meetings

• Collective management of security

Technical & Functional Cooperation (Mid - 19th century)

Industrial Revolution increased

• Trade • Transport • Communication

⇒ States needed rules.

• International Telegraph Union (1865)

• Universal Postal Union (1874)

• International River Commissions

→ Managed shared waterways

⇒ These were the first true treaty based permanent.

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Humanitarian Law & War Regulation:

- Congress of Paris (1856)
 - Rules for maritime warfare
- Geneva Convention (1864)
 - Protection of wounded soldiers
 - led to creation of Red Cross
- Congress of Berlin (1878)
 - Managed Balkan crisis diplomatically

Contribution:

- Created rules of war
- Developed humanitarian norms
- Promoted peaceful diplomacy
- These meetings shaped early international law principles.

Hague Conferences:-

First large-scale global peace conferences

- Discussed:
- Disarmament
 - Laws of war
 - Arbitration

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Established Permanent Court of Arbitration

Very Important :-

- Marked transition from power politics to legal regulation.
- Prelude to League of Nations.

Hurd: would say this is institutionalizing legitimacy.

Formal League of Nations to the United Nations.

League of Nations (1919-1939)

- Created after World War I under the treaty of Versailles
- First permanent global political organization aimed at collective security
- Key Organs: Assembly, Council, Permanent Court of Int. Justice

Purpose: Prevent wars, mediate disputes
promote disarmament.

Limitation: Absence of major powers (USA)
Weak enforcement.

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International Cooperation & Economic Crisis (1920s-1930s)

- Post-WWI economic instability & Great Depression highlighted need for international economic cooperation
- Efforts focused on coordinating trade, finance and reconstruction
- Impact: States realized peace required both security & economic stability.

World War II & the United Nations (1945)

- WWII showed the League's weakness & the need for a stronger organization
 - United Nations established by the UN charter (1945) to maintain peace, security and cooperation.
- Features: Security Council with Veto, General Assembly, ICJ, permanent Secretariat, universal membership.

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- Complemented by Bretton Woods Institutions (IMF & World Bank) for economic stability.

Cold War Period:-

- Expansion of specialized agencies
- Growth of economic institutions (GATT)
- UN peacekeeping operations
- Despite rivalry, institution survived
- Shows IOs can function even during conflict

Post-Cold War & Globalization (1991 - Present)

- Creation of NATO (1995)
- Rise of EU as supranational body
- Focus on:
 - Climate change → Terrorism
 - Poverty → Human rights

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Factors that contributed

1. Political Factors

- Wars in Europe
- Desire of peace
- Balance of power struggles

2. Economic Factors:

- Industrial Revolution
- Trade expansion
- Global financial crises

3. Intellectual Factors:

- Rationalism
- Secularism
- Kant's idea of perpetual peace

1. Failure of Pre-War Diplomacy (Before 1914)

European powers relied on secret alliances & power politics

Major Alliances

- Triple Alliance (1882) → Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy

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- Triple Entente (1907) → Britain, France, Russia
- No permanent international organisation to maintain peace.

Result - World War I (1914-1918)

WWI (1914-1918)

- Massive destruction across Europe
- Around 16-20 million deaths
- Proved that balance of power politics failed.
- Created demand for a permanent international peace organization

Treaty of Versailles (1919)

- Signed on 28 June 1919
- Officially ended WWI
- Introduced the concept of Collective Security

◦ ~~Provided~~ Created demand

- Provided for the creation of the League of Nations.

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League of Nations (1920-46)

- Established on 10 Jan 1920
- First Permanent international organization

Aims:

- Disarmament
- Peace Settlement
- Collective Security

Weaknesses:

- No military enforcement power
- USA did not join
- Failed to stop aggression (Italy 1935, Germany 1939)
- officially dissolved on 20 April 1946

Creation of Specialized Agencies

The Great Depression 1929 created global economic instability which increased need for international economic cooperation

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In WWI approx. 60-70 millions
death which confirmed the total
failure of the "League of Nations"

→ 1945 - Creation of UN
which replaced the League of
Nations

So many other institution
emerged

• IMF - 1944 , • World Bank - 1944

• UNESCO - 1945 , WHO - 1948